

GRADE 12 HISTORY

EUEE MASTER STUDY GUIDE

Ethiopian University Entrance Exam
Complete Exam Preparation

World & Ethiopian History 1815–1991 · Africa · Cold War · Independence

Simplified · Exam-Focused · High-Score Strategies

UNIT 1

DEVELOPMENT OF CAPITALISM & NATIONALISM 1815-1914

1.1 Development of Capitalism

Definition — Capitalism

An economic system where the means of production are privately owned, and goods/services are produced for profit in a competitive market.

- **Key features:** private ownership, free market, wage labour, profit motive, capital accumulation
- **Feudalism to Capitalism:** Enclosure movement forced peasants off land → rural workers became urban factory workers
- **Merchant capitalism:** trade-based wealth accumulation (1500s-1700s)
- **Industrial capitalism:** factory-based production using machinery

1.2 The Industrial Revolution

Definition — Industrial Revolution

The rapid development of industry using machines, starting in Britain in the 1760s-1840s, then spreading to Europe and North America.

Why Britain first?

- Abundant coal and iron ore deposits
- Strong merchant class with capital to invest
- Colonial empire provided raw materials and markets
- Agricultural revolution freed labour for factories
- Stable government and patent system encouraged invention

Key inventions:

- Steam engine (James Watt, 1769) — powered factories and locomotives
- Spinning jenny (Hargreaves), water frame (Arkwright) — textile revolution
- Railways (Stephenson's Rocket, 1829) — transformed transport

Social consequences:

- Urbanisation — growth of industrial cities (Manchester, Birmingham)
- New social classes: industrial bourgeoisie (factory owners) and proletariat (workers)
- Poor working conditions → labour movements, trade unions, socialism

- Overproduction became the main economic problem (not scarcity)

1.3 Nationalism

Definition — Nationalism

A political ideology that holds that a nation (people sharing language, culture, history) should have its own independent state.

- **Unification of Italy (1861):** Cavour (diplomacy), Garibaldi (military), Victor Emmanuel II (king). Key battles: Solferino (1859)
- **Unification of Germany (1871):** Bismarck ("Blood and Iron" policy), three wars (Danish, Austrian, Franco-Prussian). Kaiser Wilhelm I proclaimed.
- **American Civil War (1861-65):** North (Union) vs South (Confederacy) over slavery and states' rights. North won; slavery abolished (13th Amendment).

EXAM FOCUS

- Industrial Revolution causes and effects are very frequently tested.
- Know Bismarck's three wars and Garibaldi's role in Italian unification.
- Nationalism = right of a people to self-determination and independent statehood.

PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. Why did the Industrial Revolution begin in Britain? Give four reasons.
2. Compare the unification of Italy and Germany.
3. What is nationalism? How did it contribute to WWI?

UNIT 2

AFRICA AND THE COLONIAL EXPERIENCE 1880S-1960S

2.1 The Scramble for Africa

Definition — Scramble for Africa

The rapid colonisation of nearly all of Africa by European powers between 1881 and 1914. By 1914, only Ethiopia and Liberia remained independent.

- **Berlin Conference (1884-85):** European powers divided Africa without consulting Africans. "Effective occupation" required to claim territory.
- **Main colonial powers:** Britain, France, Germany, Belgium, Portugal, Italy, Spain

Motives (3 Es + Social Darwinism):

- **Economic:** raw materials (rubber, cotton, minerals), markets for manufactured goods
- **Political:** national prestige, strategic locations, naval bases
- **Social/Religious:** "Civilising mission" (paternalistic racism), spread of Christianity
- **Social Darwinism:** racist ideology that Europeans were "superior" and had duty to "civilise" Africans

2.2 African Resistance

- **Ethiopia — Battle of Adwa (1896):** Emperor Menelik II decisively defeated Italian forces. Only African victory stopping full colonisation. Italy recognised Ethiopian independence (Treaty of Addis Ababa).
- **Mahdist Revolt (Sudan):** Muhammad Ahmad (the Mahdi) drove out British/Egyptian forces temporarily
- **Maji Maji Rebellion (Tanzania, 1905-07):** against German rule; crushed brutally
- **Herero Uprising (Namibia, 1904):** Germany's first genocide — 80% of Herero killed

2.3 Colonial Administration Systems

- **Direct rule (France, Germany):** imposed French/German laws, culture, language; dismantled traditional authority
- **Indirect rule (Britain):** used existing African chiefs as local administrators; cheaper and more stable

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- **Settler colonialism:** Europeans settled permanently (South Africa, Kenya, Zimbabwe/Rhodesia, Algeria)

EXAM FOCUS

- Battle of Adwa (1896) — date, leader, significance — always in EUEE.
- Berlin Conference 1884-85: know what was decided and who attended.
- Direct vs indirect rule: clear comparison needed.

UNIT 3

ETHIOPIA: SOCIAL, ECONOMIC & POLITICAL DEVELOPMENTS 19TH C. TO 1941

3.5 The Victory of Adwa (1896)

Background: Italy colonised Eritrea and Somalia and wanted Ethiopia too. The Treaty of Wuchale (1889) — Italy claimed it made Ethiopia an Italian protectorate (Art. 17). Ethiopia rejected this interpretation.

- **Emperor Menelik II:** modernised army, collected weapons from France and Russia, mobilised 100,000+ troops
- **Battle (1 March 1896):** Italian forces under General Baratieri were decisively defeated; ~7,000 Italians killed/captured
- **Significance:** confirmed Ethiopian independence; inspired Pan-Africanist movement globally; Italy recognised Ethiopian sovereignty (Treaty of Addis Ababa, October 1896)

3.7 Power Struggle and Consolidation

- **Ras Tafari (Haile Selassie):** became regent 1916, king 1928, Emperor 1930
- Modernisation: schools, army, legal system, League of Nations membership (1923)
- **Italian Invasion (1935-36):** Mussolini invaded using banned chemical weapons (mustard gas). Ethiopia fell May 1936.

PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. What were the causes of the Battle of Adwa? What was its significance?
2. Compare direct and indirect colonial administration.
3. What role did the Treaty of Wuchale play in the Italian-Ethiopian conflict?

UNIT 4

SOCIETY & POLITICS IN THE AGE OF WORLD WARS 1914-1945

4.1 World War I (1914-1918)

MAIN causes:

- **M — Militarism:** arms race between European powers (especially Germany and Britain)
- **A — Alliances:** Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) vs Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain)
- **I — Imperialism:** competition for colonies created tensions
- **N — Nationalism:** especially in the Balkans ("powder keg of Europe")
- **Trigger:** assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand (28 June 1914) in Sarajevo by Gavrilo Princip

Key events & outcome:

- USA entered 1917 after German submarine warfare; Russia left after Revolution
- **Treaty of Versailles (1919):** Germany blamed (War Guilt Clause, Art. 231); huge reparations (132 billion gold marks); lost territory; army limited to 100,000; League of Nations created

4.2 Russian Revolution (1917)

- **February Revolution:** Tsar Nicholas II overthrown; Provisional Government formed
- **October Revolution:** Bolsheviks (Lenin, Trotsky) seized power; "Peace, Land, Bread"
- **Civil War (1918-21):** Red Army (Bolsheviks) vs White Army (conservatives); Reds won
- **USSR formed 1922:** world's first communist state; command economy

4.4 World War II (1939-1945)

Causes:

- Harsh Treaty of Versailles → German resentment → rise of Hitler and Nazism
- Great Depression (1929) → economic desperation
- Appeasement policy failed (Munich Agreement 1938 — gave Sudetenland to Hitler)

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- **Trigger:** Germany invaded Poland (1 September 1939) → Britain and France declared war

Key events:

- Battle of Britain (1940), Operation Barbarossa (Germany invaded USSR 1941)
- Pearl Harbor (Dec 1941) → USA joined the war
- D-Day/Normandy Invasion (6 June 1944) → liberation of Western Europe
- Atomic bombs on Hiroshima (6 Aug) and Nagasaki (9 Aug 1945) → Japan surrendered
- **End:** Germany surrendered 8 May 1945 (V-E Day); Japan 2 September 1945 (V-J Day)

EXAM FOCUS

- WWI causes: MAIN acronym. Trigger = assassination of Franz Ferdinand.
- Treaty of Versailles terms — all five points are testable.
- WWII: know causes, key battles, turning points, and how it ended.

UNIT 5

GLOBAL & REGIONAL DEVELOPMENTS SINCE 1945

5.2 The United Nations (UN)

Definition — United Nations

International organisation founded in 1945 to maintain peace, promote human rights, and foster international cooperation. Replaced the League of Nations.

- **Main organs:** General Assembly (all members), Security Council (5 permanent members + 10 rotating), Secretariat, ICJ, ECOSOC
- **P5 (Veto power):** USA, UK, France, Russia, China
- **Key UN bodies:** UNICEF, UNHCR, WHO, UNESCO, FAO

5.4 The Cold War (1947–1991)

Definition — Cold War

Political, ideological, and military tension between USA (capitalism/democracy) and USSR (communism) that never became direct military conflict.

- **Truman Doctrine (1947):** US policy to contain communism; military/economic aid to Greece and Turkey
- **Marshall Plan (1947):** US economic aid to rebuild Western Europe (\$13 billion)
- **NATO (1949):** Western military alliance
- **Warsaw Pact (1955):** Soviet military alliance
- **Korean War (1950–53):** UN forces (led by US) vs North Korea (backed by China/USSR); ended in stalemate at 38th parallel
- **Cuban Missile Crisis (1962):** USSR placed missiles in Cuba; USA blockaded; 13-day standoff; missiles removed; hotline established
- **Vietnam War (1955–75):** US intervention failed; communist North Vietnam united country
- **End of Cold War:** Gorbachev's reforms (glasnost/perestroika); Berlin Wall fell 1989; USSR dissolved 1991

EXAM FOCUS

- Cold War: capitalism vs communism; USA vs USSR. Know key events with dates.
- Cuban Missile Crisis 1962 is one of the most tested Cold War events.
- UN organs and functions — frequently asked.

UNIT 6

ETHIOPIA: INTERNAL DEVELOPMENTS & EXTERNAL INFLUENCES 1941-1991

6.4 The 1974 Revolution

Causes of the Revolution:

- Severe famine (Wollo, 1972-74) — government hid it, exposed by BBC/Jonathan Dimbleby
- Economic crisis, inflation, student protests, military discontent
- Land tenure system — most land owned by church, nobility, and state
- **Haile Selassie deposed:** 12 September 1974 by the Derg (military committee)
- **Derg:** Coordinating Committee of the Armed Forces, Police and Territorial Army (Mengistu emerged as leader)

Derg policies:

- **Land reform (1975):** all land nationalised, redistributed to peasants ("Land to the Tiller")
- **Zemetcha campaign:** urban youth sent to rural areas to implement reforms
- **Nationalisation:** banks, industries, businesses taken by the state
- **Red Terror (1977-78):** brutal suppression of opposition (thousands killed)

6.6 Downfall of the Derg

- Eritrean independence struggle (EPLF), Tigray (TPLF), Oromo (OLF) armed opposition
- Severe famine 1984-85 (Live Aid concerts raised international awareness)
- Collapse of Soviet support after USSR dissolved
- **1991:** EPRDF forces captured Addis Ababa; Mengistu fled to Zimbabwe; Derg collapsed

UNIT 7

AFRICA SINCE THE 1960S

7.1 African Independence

Definition — Decolonisation

The process by which African countries gained independence from European colonial powers, mainly between 1957 and 1975.

- **Gold Coast (Ghana) first:** 1957 under Kwame Nkrumah; "Ghana's independence is meaningless unless linked to total liberation of Africa"
- **Year of Africa (1960):** 17 African nations gained independence
- **OAU (1963):** Organisation of African Unity; headquartered in Addis Ababa; promote unity and end colonialism
- **AU (2002):** African Union replaced OAU; broader mandate including peace and development

UNIT 8

POST-1991 ETHIOPIA

- **Transitional Government:** 1991–1995; EPRDF led; designed new federal structure
- **1995 Constitution:** Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia; ethnic federalism; 9 regional states + 2 city administrations
- **Eritrean independence (1993):** referendum, 99.8% voted yes; Ethiopia became landlocked
- **Ethiopia-Eritrea War (1998–2000):** border dispute; Algiers Agreement 2000

LAST-MINUTE REVISION GUIDE

Battle of Adwa	1 March 1896; Menelik II vs Italy (Baratieri); Ethiopia won
Berlin Conference	1884–85; Africa divided among European powers
WWI trigger	Assassination of Franz Ferdinand, 28 June 1914, Sarajevo
WWI end	11 November 1918; Treaty of Versailles 1919
Russian Revolution	October 1917; Lenin/Bolsheviks; formed USSR 1922
WWII start/end	1 Sep 1939 – 8 May 1945 (Europe); 2 Sep 1945 (Japan)

UN founded	1945; replaced League of Nations; HQ New York
Cold War	1947-1991; USA(capitalism) vs USSR(communism)
Cuban Missile Crisis	1962; 13-day standoff; USSR missiles removed from Cuba
Year of Africa	1960; 17 nations independent
OAU	1963; Addis Ababa; replaced by AU 2002
1974 Revolution	Derg overthrew Haile Selassie; land reform 1975
Derg fell	1991; EPRDF took power; Mengistu fled
1995 Constitution	Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia; 9 regions

EUEE EXAM STRATEGY

Time Management

- **Skim first (5 min):** Read all questions. Mark easy (E), medium (M), hard (H).
- **Easy first:** Answer all E questions to bank safe marks and build confidence.
- **Pace yourself:** Aim for ~2 minutes per question. If stuck over 3 minutes, skip and return.
- **Show working:** Even wrong answers earn partial marks if steps are correct.
- **Final review:** Use last 10 minutes to check calculations, names, and dates.

Answering Techniques

- Multiple-choice: eliminate obviously wrong answers first, then choose from what remains.
- Definition questions: always include the key term in your answer.
- Explanation questions: structure as Definition → Example → Importance.
- Diagram questions: label all parts, use arrows correctly, add units where needed.
- Essay questions: write a clear intro, 3-4 main points with evidence, strong conclusion.

Common Exam Traps

- Confusing similar terms — always define the exact term asked.
- Incomplete answers — re-read every question before finalising.
- Time overrun — if a question takes too long, note it and move on.
- Skipping diagrams — a well-labelled diagram often earns more marks than a paragraph.
- Not reading all options in MCQ — always read all four choices before selecting.